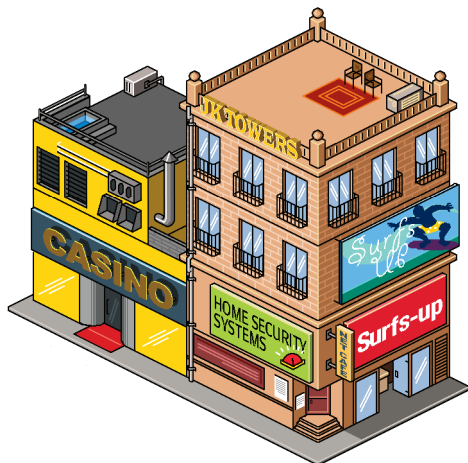


Dorgem

Another streaming application to try out is Dorgem, it has some pretty advanced features and is Open Source.

Advanced Eyespyfx

If your webcam has a mount and rotor, you can use Eyespyfx to remotely pan and tilt the camera as well.



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You do not need expensive equipment or software to set up a simple video surveillance system at your home or office. Any standard web cam and a computer will suffice for the basic surveillance setups outlined below. There are two scenarios under consideration, one that stores data locally, for set-ups without internet access, and another to stream the video over the internet onto various platforms. If you don't already have a web cam, look for one with a long cord, and something small and discreet, as well as a mount, if you need to locate the web cam against the walls. Many web cams come with clip-mounts, which can be used to place the web cam at strategic locations. If you're using devices such as netbooks with inbuilt cameras, be sure to change the battery settings in a way that the machine does not go into sleep mode on inactivity. If you are using a laptop or a netbook for long periods of surveillance, which is not advisable, remove the battery from the casing and use the power cable only, to lengthen the life of your battery.

Using Yawcam for offline surveillance

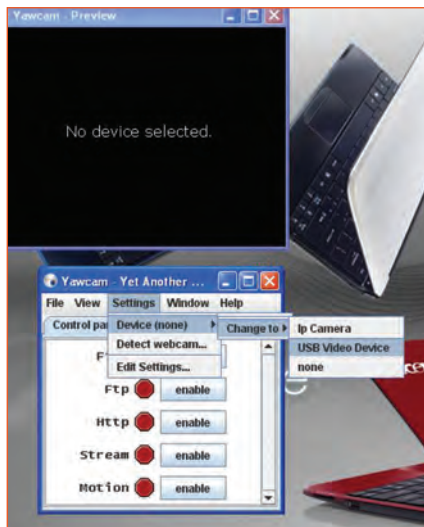
Yawcam stands for Yet Another Webcam application, and is a small software that can be downloaded from www.yawcam.com. It is a small program that packs in plenty

TIME TO WATCH OUT

If you need a simple, straightforward way to monitor a location using basic equipment, locally or over the internet, read on...

of features. The software also has motion detection, a feature that can be used to trigger recording as and when there is any activity in the area under surveillance.

Step 1: On first start after the application is installed, you will have to select a source for the video. An inbuilt camera on the system, a video camera attached through USB, or a web cam can all be detected by Yawcam. Go to **Settings > Device(None) > Change** to and select the source of the video. If there is no option here, make sure that a camera is connected, and all the relevant drivers



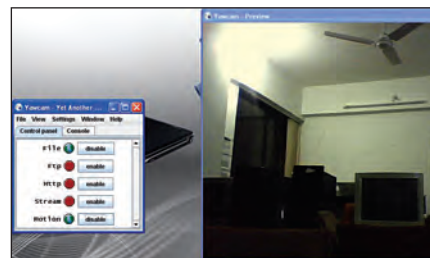
Selecting a video source

installed. Once selected, the video window will immediately start showing a live stream.

Step 2: In the main Control Panel tab of Yawcam, are five basic toggles. File, FTP, HTTP, Stream and Motion. Click on File. This will start saving the stream onto the local hard disk, in a temporary directory. Go to **Settings > Edit Settings > Output > File**.

Click on Browse to change a path to a suitable location on your hard disk. The Image quality option allows you to reduce the file size of the stored images if you are conservative about disk space. The Type option has a few file formats, JPG is an ideal format. The interval option specifies a number of seconds after which an image will be saved.

Step 3: Enabling motion detection saves a photo every time there is some change in the image on the webcam. Unfortunately, there is a "click" sound when the image is saved. There is no easy way to turn this off, and reducing the system volume is the only alternative. Be sure to select this option at the very last moment, before



Motion detection in Yawcam

the surveillance begins, as there will be a few images saved as and when you move around after enabling it.

Step 4: Yawcam also allows you to save the images on a remote location, such as an FTP server. For online surveillance, a better option would be to stream live video, but if you do want to save to a remote location, enable the FTP toggle, go to **Settings > Edit Settings > Output > FTP** and enter in the details of your FTP account. You will need an IP address, a password, and the authentication details. While Yawcam also allows you to stream content online, there is a